



January 22, 2026

Joseph Luis (Joseph) Igot
2709 Maine Ave
Clovis, CA 93619-9273

Dear Joseph,

Congratulations! On behalf of Rice University, I offer you admission to the Doctor of Philosophy program in the Rice University Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering as a full-time student, beginning in the fall semester of 2026. After careful review of a large and very competitive applicant pool, our faculty concluded that you have exceptional potential to succeed in scholarship and research. We commend you for the superb work that you have done to merit doctoral admission.

Our world-renowned faculty would welcome you as a junior colleague, and we expect that you would thrive at Rice. Here, you would join a close-knit and vibrant group academic community in which each young scholar achieves at the highest level with the support of the community. I expect that you'll find that our grad students are unusually happy. We select for people who have the talent and drive to excel as scholars, and we provide the mentorship, support, and resources that students need to perform world-class scholarship.

Houston is a fantastic place in which to live and study. As home to the nation's largest port, we are a melting pot of people from all around the country and all around the world. That diversity has created one of the best and most competitive restaurant scenes in the country. We are honestly spoiled by the rich culture and unlimited affordable dining options.

The Rice standard doctoral stipend support is \$37,000 per twelve-month appointment, and can be a research assistantship or teaching assistantship or fellowship, funded by the graduate program, school, grants, or external fellowships. A few programs provide some additional funding, and information regarding your graduate payments and financial support can be found in the letter from the graduate program. Throughout the period in which you are supported as a research assistant, teaching assistant, or fellow, the Office of Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies will waive your doctoral tuition (worth over \$60,000 per year). Graduate student payments are subject to all of the usual federal taxes; please review [this website](#) for information on graduate student payments and tax information.

Rice offers additional financial support to students who earn external fellowships, so please alert us if you enter these competitions or have other news to share. If you are awarded an outside graduate fellowship that includes stipend, tuition, health insurance, and/or cost-of-education allowances, we expect you to accept that award in place of our fellowship. The university will provide a partial tuition waiver to make up any difference between the outside award and the Rice award tuition.

All graduate students at Rice are required to pay fees each year. The fees for 2025-26 are \$750, and may increase somewhat each year. Students are also required to have health insurance coverage, which must be



purchased through the university plan or on your own. The university will provide a medical insurance subsidy to cover the full premium (100%) to all full-time doctoral students who are enrolled in the Rice University health insurance plan during their first six years of doctoral study at Rice. Information regarding the Rice health care policy is available at studenthealthinsurance.rice.edu. Current information related to tuition, student fees, and insurance is available at bursar.rice.edu.

University practices concerning graduate students are available through the [General Announcements](#), the [Student Code of Conduct](#), and policies.rice.edu. The graduate program has published a graduate program handbook that will serve as a guide to you throughout your program ([link here](#)). It would be good to familiarize yourself with these documents before you begin the program.

Doctoral Student Orientation on August 19, 2026, is mandatory. Please keep an eye out for communication on any other relevant orientations (for example, these might include orientation for your specific degree program or school). Additional information for incoming Rice Graduate students, including required online training sessions, will be available on the Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies website at <https://graduate.rice.edu/admissions/after-admission>. Please be advised that the Student Health Form is due July 15, 2026. Online training must be completed before October 1, 2026.

Since there are other qualified applicants for our graduate program, we can leave this offer open only until April 15, 2026. After that date, we reserve the right to withdraw the offer. This offer of admission is provisional, pending the receipt of your final transcript from your undergraduate institution before October 1, 2026. Please use the reply form on your admissions status page to notify us of your decision.

Please stay in close contact with your graduate program! Your department's faculty, students, and staff are anxious to connect and help support your decision-making. I also encourage you to visit our website to learn about our commitment to a community, our support for professional development, fellowship coaching, and more.

Once again, congratulations on your admission! I hope to have the opportunity to work with you.

With all best regards,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Seiichi Matsuda".

Seiichi Matsuda
Dean of Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies